SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #33 · SUCCESS, STATUS AND MONEY

"Money and things will make me happy."

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Where it often comes from

We are surrounded by messages that the right income and possessions deliver contentment. Seeing the relief money brings in a crisis reinforces it. The pursuit can take over life and relationships, and each level reached shows another one to chase.

What Scripture teaches

Solomon writes, "He who loves money is never satisfied by money, and he who loves wealth is never satisfied by income. This too is futile." Jesus said, "Do not store up for yourselves treasures on earth… For where your treasure is, there your heart will be also." He asks, "What does it profit a man to gain the whole world, yet forfeit his soul?" Paul tells the rich "not to put their hope in the uncertainty of wealth, but in God, who richly provides all things for us to enjoy." God is not against enjoying good things. He warns that they cannot carry the weight of our hearts.

> *"He who loves money is never satisfied by money, and he who loves wealth is never satisfied by income. This too is futile"* (Ecclesiastes 5:10).

Also see

> "Do not store up for yourselves treasures on earth, where moth and rust destroy, and where thieves break in and steal. But store up for yourselves treasures in heaven, where moth and rust do not destroy, and where thieves do not break in and steal. For where your treasure is, there your heart will be also" (Matthew 6:19–21).

> "Instruct those who are rich in the present age not to be conceited and not to put their hope in the uncertainty of wealth, but in God, who richly provides all things for us to enjoy. Instruct them to do good, to be rich in good works, and to be generous and ready to share, treasuring up for themselves a firm foundation for the future, so that they may take hold of that which is truly life" (1 Timothy 6:17–19).

> "And He said to them, 'Watch out! Guard yourselves against every form of greed, for one's life does not consist in the abundance of his possessions.'" (Luke 12:15).

> "What does it profit a man to gain the whole world, yet forfeit his soul?" (Mark 8:36).

Common self-statements

- I will be happy when I earn more.
- More money would fix everything.
- The next raise will do it.
- Things make life good.
- I need more to feel secure.
- If I could just afford that, I would be content.

Common logical errors

- Magical thinking: Believing that more money guarantees happiness.
- Postponement: Delaying contentment until later.
- Social comparison: Chasing what others have.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling wanting and concluding it must be filled by money.

Challenging questions

- What have I hoped money would give me?
- When have I had more and been no happier?
- What gives me lasting joy that is not for sale?
- Where is my treasure, and where is my heart?
- What does Scripture say about the limits of wealth?
- What is one way to enjoy what I have and share it?

Truth summary

> Money is a useful tool and a poor master. It cannot give lasting happiness. My hope is in God, who richly provides things to enjoy. I can use money wisely, enjoy it, and share it.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Riches, Beware of
- Riches, True
- Greedy/Stingy
- Money
- Joy

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Money/Riches
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Already There — Casting Crowns
God's perspective extends beyond what we can currently understand.

Forever — Kari Jobe
Christ's resurrection grounds hope in His victory over sin and death.

Thrive — Casting Crowns
Life rooted in God includes purposeful growth and joy, not merely surviving or staying busy.

How Great Thou Art — Jordan Smith
This classic hymn connects God's greatness, Christ's sacrifice, and future hope.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Money and things will make me happy"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Money and things will make me happy." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I hope money gives?
- ☐ When did more not satisfy?
- ☐ What joy is free?
- ☐ Where is my treasure?
- ☐ What is enough?
- ☐ What can I give?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Money cannot satisfy.
- ☐ My treasure should be in heaven.
- ☐ Hope belongs in God, not wealth.
- ☐ God provides things to enjoy.
- ☐ Generosity brings joy.
- ☐ I can be content with enough.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Ecclesiastes 5:10

  "He who loves money is never satisfied by money, and he who loves wealth is never satisfied by income. This too is futile."

- ☐ Matthew 6:19–21

  "Do not store up for yourselves treasures on earth, where moth and rust destroy, and where thieves break in and steal. But store up for yourselves treasures in heaven, where moth and rust do not destroy, and where thieves do not break in and steal. For where your treasure is, there your heart will be also."

- ☐ 1 Timothy 6:17–19

  "Instruct those who are rich in the present age not to be conceited and not to put their hope in the uncertainty of wealth, but in God, who richly provides all things for us to enjoy. Instruct them to do good, to be rich in good works, and to be generous and ready to share, treasuring up for themselves a firm foundation for the future, so that they may take hold of that which is truly life."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Lasting joy: Each week, note one source of joy that did not cost money.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Ecclesiastes 5:10 becomes: "Sarah can write: "My treasure is in heaven, so money will not decide my happiness.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Riches, Beware of" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] Examine the promise. Write what you hope more money will give.
- [ ] List free joys. Write ten sources of joy that do not cost money.
- [ ] Give something. Share money or time with someone in need.
- [ ] Set an enough. Define a level of income or spending that is enough.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Money and things will make me happy": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Lasting joy
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Money and things will make me happy.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have looked to money for happiness. Teach me to use it wisely, to enjoy Your gifts, and to find my joy in You. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.